

Lower thoracic esophageal cancer: Squamous cell cancer, incompletely staged

AFROC

Dr. Solomon Hunegnaw Bezabih

MD, Clinical Oncologist

HUCTC

History and physical exam

- A 30-year-old male patient from Sidama region of Ethiopia who presented with progressive dysphagia to solid food followed by inability to take even fluid diet over 08 months duration associated with unquantified weight loss.
- No history of cigarette smoking and alcohol consumption.
- No known comorbid illness
- PE
- Stable but CSL, weight = 43kg
- ECOG1
- No other positive pertinent finding

Pertinent investigations

- **CBC, LFT and RFT** were all in the normal range, his albumin being 3.1 g/dl.
- **Upper GI endoscopy** showed a critical narrowing at 34cm from central incisor with ulcer and mucosal thickening and multiple biopsies were taken.
- **Biopsy : esophagus** : invasive keratinizing squamous cell carcinoma
- **CT chest** : reported as diffusely dilated esophagus which tappers at the GEJ with a maximum diameter of 4.5cm. No obstructing mass lesion or thickening was reported on CT scan and no pathological lymph nodes or distant metastasis to the lungs and liver was reported.

Management

- Ass't : **Grade V dysphagia secondary to lower thoracic esophageal ca : CTxN?OMO**
- **Emergency feeding tube insertion(gastrostomy)** was decided from cardiothoracic surgery unit and feeding tube was inserted. And he was linked to Oncology unit.
- At Oncology unit, repeat CT scan was planned but was not done for financial reason. And CCRT was also planned but due to Linac breakdown, he was started on induction chemotherapy with FP regimen.

Rx: con'd

- 5fu 2400mg/m²=3552mf 48-hour infusion with leucovorin 200mg iv every 14 days
- Cisplatin 60mg/m² =89 iv/ 500ml NS every 14 days
- He currently took 3 cycles of chemo and has tolerated well with no cycle interruption and 3 kgs of weight gain.

Points of discussion

- Esophageal cancer in young individuals
- Proper staging workups
- Appropriate treatment approaches and role of induction chemo in esophageal cancer treatment
- Further treatment plans.
- ???

- Thanks!!!